

Toolkit: How to Hold a “Missing Member” Town Hall

Practical guide for organizing your own town hall when your Representative refuses to show up

Lady Libertie, The American Pamphleteer

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The List of Checklists

- Planning Checklist
- Sample Invitation to Your Representative
- Press Release Template
- Social Media Posts & Slogans
- Milk Carton Sign Template
- Event Day Roles
- Tips for Keeping It Civil & Safe
- Follow-Up Actions



1. Planning Checklist

3-4 Weeks Before:

- Choose a venue: school, community center, church, library, union hall
- Lock in a date and time that works for your community (evenings or weekends)
- Invite speakers (e.g., policy experts, local officials, teachers, activists, constitutional scholars)
- Reach out to local press and independent media

2 Weeks Before:

- Send formal invite to your Representative
- Promote on social media, local calendars, flyers, and church/community bulletin boards
- Set up an RSVP system (Eventbrite, Google Form, etc.)
- Create signs, stage visuals (including the “Missing Member” milk carton)

1 Week Before:

- Confirm all logistics: chairs, microphones, livestream setup, signage
- Assign roles (greeters, moderator, press liaison, security contact)
- Prep materials for voter reg, petitions, next actions
- Practice run-through with speakers

Day Of:

- Show up early. Run a tech check. Set up sign-in and handouts.
- Have someone on mic to welcome people and explain the format
- Record or livestream if possible
- End with a call to action—don’t let the energy drop

2. Sample Invitation to Your Representative

Dear Representative [Last Name],

On behalf of your constituents in [District Name], we are organizing a public Town Hall to discuss critical national issues including [insert key topics: healthcare, public services, constitutional protections, etc.]. The event will take place on [Date] at [Location], and we would be honored to have you attend and hear directly from your constituents.

We hope this will be an opportunity for open dialogue and accountability, especially in this moment of historic consequence for our democracy.

Please RSVP by [Date] to [Contact Info]. The public is eager to hear from you.

*Sincerely,
[Your Name]
[Organization or Affiliation, if applicable]
[Phone Number]
[Email Address]*



3. Press Release Template

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

[Your City, Date] — In response to [Representative Name]’s ongoing refusal to meet with constituents, local residents are holding their own Town Hall on [Date] at [Time] at [Location].

This event, titled “**Where’s [Rep’s Name]?**”, will feature community leaders, policy experts, and residents from across the district discussing the impacts of recent federal actions and the importance of congressional oversight.

A symbolic “Missing Member” milk carton will be displayed in lieu of the absent Representative, and organizers will share ways citizens can get involved in protecting democratic institutions.

Media are welcome. RSVP to [Contact Name] at [Email] or [Phone].



4. Social Media Posts & Slogans

Instagram/Twitter/X Threads:

- “Our Rep won’t meet with us, so we’re meeting without them. Join us for a Town Hall on [Date]. We’ll save them a seat.
#MissingMember #TownHallForThePeople”
- “Democracy doesn’t take a day off. [Rep’s Name] did. We’re hosting our own Town Hall. [Date/Time/Location] #WhereIs[Name] #HoldThemAccountable”
- “Bring a friend. Bring your questions. Bring your voice. Our Town Hall, our terms. [Location/Date/Time] #PeoplePower #WeShowUpEvenIfTheyDont”

Slogans for signs/posters:

- “Where’s [Rep’s Name]?”
- “AWOL and Unaccountable”
- “MIA: Member of Congress”
- “We Showed Up. Why Didn’t You?”
- “Constituents Not Consultants”

5. Milk Carton Sign Template

**Bonus points for
setting it on the
stage with a chair
marked
“Reserved.”**

MISSING
IN ACTION

PHOTO OF
REP

REP NAME:

LAST SEEN:

STATUS:

Event Day Roles

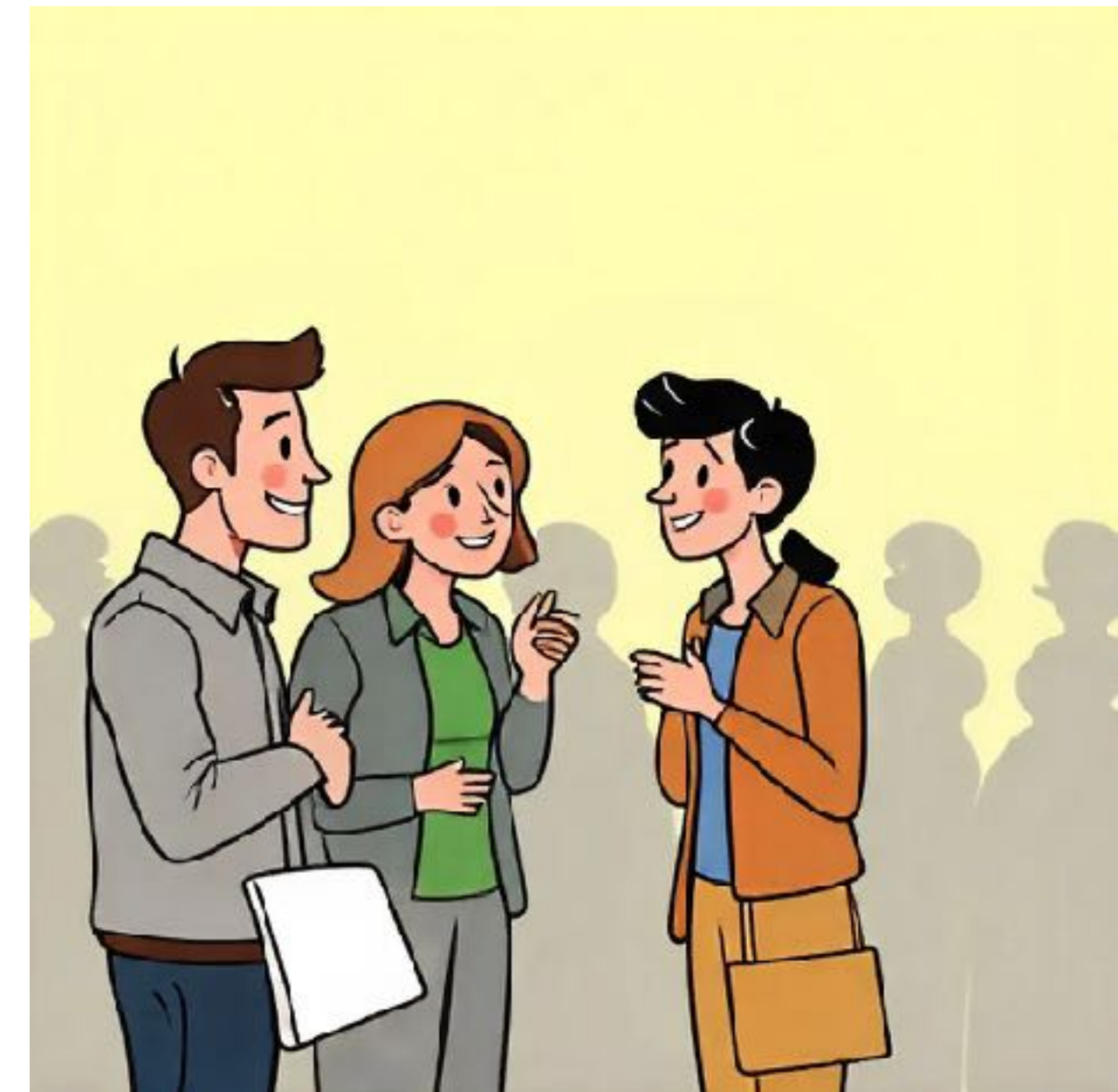
- **Moderator:** Keeps the meeting on track, time checks speakers
- **Greeters:** Sign people in, hand out programs or flyers
- **Mic Runners:** For audience Q&A
- **Security Liaison:** Works with local volunteers to maintain safety (especially if protesters or disruptors show)
- **Press Contact:** Greets reporters, hands out press kits
- **Photographer/Videographer:** Captures the moment for social and press



Tips for Keeping It Civil & Safe

Even with tempers high, keep it peaceful and respectful.

- Start with a group agreement: No personal attacks. No hate speech. Listen actively.
- Use a timer for audience questions to give everyone a turn.
- Have trained de-escalators on hand if tensions rise.
- If counter-protesters show up, don't engage. Let your message stay focused.



Follow-Up Actions

- Send a recap to press with key quotes and photos.
- Share videos on social media and tag the Rep.
- Launch a petition or voter pledge campaign.
- Ask participants to send a followup postcard
- Announce your next meeting—keep the momentum alive.



Follow-Up Postcard

If you really want to put the fear of democracy into your representatives, ask all participants to send a postcard.

Why?

- It proves you're local. Takes the wind right out of the "outside agitators" lie.
- It's tangible. A physical stack of postcards hitting their mailbox? That lands harder than 10,000 tweets.
- It personalizes the protest. A name, a zip code, and a quick message are a triple threat: human, direct, and hard to ignore.
- It builds momentum. People feel more involved when they have a small, clear action to take.

A Few Notes for Maximum Impact:

- Yes, ask for name and zip code. Full address is optional

- Pre-print the cards with your event branding and a clear, bold headline like:

"I showed up. You didn't."

Constituent of [ZIP CODE] / [Town], [State]

Here's what I need from my Representative...

- Give them prompts. Not everyone knows what to write, so offer examples like:
 - "I'm a voter in your district. Please start holding public town halls."
 - "I oppose cuts to [Medicare / USPS / education, etc.] and want your support."
 - "Why won't you meet with us?"
- Offer a mailing station. Provide stamps or collect cards and mail them all at once (bulk mail = big visual).
- Follow up with a photo. A shot of 300 postcards stacked next to the "MIA" milk carton? That's gold!

**And remember:
We don't wait for permission.
We don't beg for transparency.
*We build it ourselves.***

**With fire and resolve,
- Lady Libertie
The American Pamphleteer**